

Grateful & Grounded Kids

CHORES and RESPONSIBILITY

Family Chores & Work Accountability Plan

A framework for cultivating responsibility, gratitude, and shared ownership in the home

www.RichRoadStewardship.com

1 Our Family Vision for Work & Responsibility

Work is not a punishment or a transaction, but rather a meaningful way our family cares for one another and learns how life works.

As a family, we commit to involving our children in the shared work of the home so they grow in responsibility, humility, perseverance, and gratitude. By contributing as co-workers in our household, our children learn that privileges are supported by responsibility, and that serving others is a normal part of life.

Guiding Scripture (optional):

☐ Colossians 3:23–24

☐ Other: _____

☐ Luke 16:10

2 Core Principles (Our Non-Negotiables)

☐ Build shared ownership rather than entitlement

☐ Reduce nagging through clarity and accountability

☐ Teach responsibility before independence

☐ Protect relationships by remaining calm and respectful

☐ Be age-appropriate but meaningful

☐ Emphasize honesty, effort, and follow-through

☐ Other: _____

3 Why We Expect Our Kids to Work

Including kids in meaningful household work helps them understand how life works, builds confidence and competence, and develops habits that carry into adulthood.

Work teaches our children:

- This home belongs to all of us
- My contribution matters
- Privileges are supported by responsibility
- Serving others is a normal part of life

4 Household Responsibilities (Baseline Chores)

These chores are required as part of being a member of our family. They are not paid and are expected to be completed with reasonable effort and honesty.

Examples of baseline chores:

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| • Dishes / kitchen clean-up | • Floors and common spaces |
| • Laundry (sorting, washing, folding) | • Pet care |
| • Bathrooms | • Room upkeep |
| • Trash and recycling | • Setting and clearing the table |

Other examples: _____

5 Accountability System

Our family will use the following system to track chores:

- | | |
|--------------------------------------|--|
| ☐ Chore chart | ☐ Digital system (e.g., Skylight) |
| ☐ Whiteboard | ☐ Other: _____ |

We agree that chores will be visible, children will check them off themselves, and parents will verify completion without nagging.

6 Privileges & Responsibilities

Privileges are not entitlements. They are benefits of living in our home and are maintained by fulfilling responsibilities.

Examples of privileges in our home:

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Screen time / phone access | ☐ Staying up late |
| ☐ Social activities / sleepovers | ☐ Treats or special activities |
| ☐ Games, toys, or special items | ☐ Other: _____ |

7 Consequences for Incomplete or Dishonest Work

When chores are not completed, completed poorly, or checked off dishonestly:

- A privilege will be removed
- The chore still must be completed
- Parents will remain calm and consistent

We agree to let loss of privileges do the teaching—not nagging or frustration.

8 Attitude, Honesty & Asking for Help

We expect chores to be completed with a reasonable attitude. Asking for help is encouraged before deadlines pass.

How to ask for help in our home:

What honesty looks like in our home:

9 Paid Work & Extra Jobs (Optional)

Some work opportunities may earn money and are separate from required chores.

Examples of paid jobs:

- | | |
|---|--------------------------|
| • Yard work (mowing, shoveling) | • Babysitting |
| • Large cleaning or organization projects | • Special one-time tasks |

Other paid jobs: _____

10 Parent Commitments

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Be clear and consistent | ☐ Treat children as capable contributors |
| ☐ Not nag, yell, or lecture | ☐ Remember that requiring work serves our children's development |
| ☐ Follow through calmly with consequences | ☐ Other: _____ |

11 Grace, Growth & Review

We recognize that no plan is perfect. When mistakes happen, we will respond with honesty, grace, and a commitment to growth.

This plan will be reviewed:

- ☐ Quarterly ☐ Semi-annually ☐ Annually

12 Family Commitment

By signing below, we agree to uphold this Chores & Work Accountability Plan with clarity, consistency, and grace.

Parent: _____ Date: _____

Parent: _____ Date: _____

Child: _____ Date: _____

Child: _____ Date: _____

Child: _____ Date: _____